

FDE-Associate Foundation — Skills & Connectors

Extremely Difficult Scenario-Based MCQ Examination • 35 Questions

Source basis: Panaversity “Skills & Connectors: Teach AI Once, Connect It to Your Apps” (reviewed in full). Questions emphasize implementation judgment, troubleshooting, security, portability, and architecture rather than recall.

Question 1

A finance team repeats the same monthly-close procedure, but the ledger remains in Drive and the team wants the output in a fixed four-section format. They currently paste the ledger into chat and restate the formatting rules every month. What architecture best removes both sources of friction while preserving human review?

- A. A Project containing the ledger plus custom instructions, with no connector
- B. A Connector with write access to Drive and no reusable instructions
- C. A Skill for the reporting procedure plus a scoped Drive Connector for the live ledger
- D. A custom instruction that tells the model to remember the ledger and report format

Answer: C

Question 2

An installed client-summary Skill never activates when users say “prepare the month-end report,” although its body contains the correct workflow. The Skill activates when explicitly named. Investigation shows the description only says “Helps with reports.” What is the most targeted fix?

- A. Move the full workflow into the description
- B. Add the users’ trigger phrases and make the description specific about the task
- C. Give the Skill write access to the accounting system
- D. Convert the Skill into a Project so it is always loaded

Answer: B

Question 3

A team connects a tracker so an AI assistant can summarize tickets. The assistant can see some tickets but cannot find a specific project board that the user can open manually. The connector is enabled for the chat. Which investigation should happen first?

- A. Rewrite the Skill’s instructions
- B. Increase the model context window
- C. Grant organization-wide administrator access
- D. Check the user’s permissions and the connector’s scope for that board

Answer: D

Question 4

A Skill produces correct reports for the first few messages, then begins omitting required sections after a very long conversation. The same Skill works correctly in a fresh chat with identical input. What is the best diagnosis and response?

- A. The Skill is fundamentally malformed; rewrite its frontmatter
- B. The connector has lost its MCP registration; reinstall it
- C. The conversation has become tangled; start a fresh chat rather than editing the Skill
- D. The Skill needs a broader negative trigger

Answer: C

Question 5

A monthly reporting Skill must calculate totals and apply an exact withholding threshold. After repeated wording changes, it still occasionally misclassifies boundary values. Which design change best addresses the root cause described by the course?

- A. Put the exact arithmetic and threshold test in a small program within the Skill
- B. Add more examples to the natural-language description only
- C. Make the Skill load in every Project
- D. Grant the connector broader write access

Answer: A

Question 6

A marketer wants a workflow that reads this week’s scheduled posts from Notion and produces captions using a strict brand voice. The marketer also wants the same rules to work when the content comes from another source later. Which decomposition is strongest?

- A. Put the content calendar data and brand rules into custom instructions
- B. Use a Notion Connector only and rely on prompting for brand voice
- C. Use a Project containing every future content source and fixed output rules

D. D. Keep the brand voice as a Skill and use a Connector for the current content source

Answer: D

Question 7

A hospital team wants AI to summarize records. Security policy says the first pilot may read data but must not modify or send anything. Which deployment choice best matches the course's safety guidance?

- A. A. Start with read-only connector access and the smallest required data scope
- B. B. Start with write access but require a human to approve each response
- C. C. Connect the whole hospital drive so retrieval is more reliable
- D. D. Use a community Skill first because it has no connector permissions

Answer: A

Question 8

A Skill starts for both full month-end reports and unrelated quick calculations. Its instructions are correct once it starts. What is the most direct way to reduce false activations?

- A. A. Add more output examples to the body
- B. B. Narrow the description and add a negative trigger for unrelated requests
- C. C. Convert the Skill to a Connector
- D. D. Add a Project containing the accounting template

Answer: B

Question 9

An organization installs a third-party Skill from an online forum. The Skill appears to work, but its bundled files include a script that contacts an external server. What should the FDE recommend before the Skill is used with customer data?

- A. A. Enable write access so the server call can be audited
- B. B. Ignore the script because Skills are only text instructions
- C. C. Inspect the Skill and bundled files, identify external communication, and prefer trusted sources
- D. D. Move the Skill into custom instructions so the script cannot execute

Answer: C

Question 10

A company wants a reusable body of client-specific documents and standing instructions to load in every conversation for one engagement. The workflow itself should only activate when a particular task is requested. Which split is most appropriate?

- A. A. Put standing client context in a Project and the repeatable task procedure in a Skill
- B. B. Put everything in a Skill so it is progressively disclosed
- C. C. Put everything in custom instructions because the client is important
- D. D. Put standing context in the Connector and procedure in the Project

Answer: A

Question 11

An FDE tests a newly generated Skill and observes that it "flags the big payments." Two analysts interpret "big" differently, producing inconsistent results. What is the best next step?

- A. A. Add a Connector because ambiguity is caused by missing data
- B. B. Replace the vague instruction with a measurable rule such as a specific threshold
- C. C. Delete the Skill and use one-off prompts
- D. D. Move the instruction into the Project description

Answer: B

Question 12

A Drive connector can read documents and save a new generated file, but it cannot edit an existing document in place. A customer insists that this limitation proves their OAuth permissions are broken. What should the FDE conclude?

- A. A. The connector must be granted administrator scope
- B. B. The Skill must be rewritten to request edit access
- C. C. The limitation may be the connector's action design rather than a permissions failure
- D. D. The customer must switch to a different model

Answer: C

Question 13

A team has ten connectors enabled in a busy workspace. Many connector actions are loaded even when unrelated to the current request, increasing clutter and unnecessary tool availability. Which setting from the course is most relevant?

- A. A. Load actions on demand so tools are loaded when the request needs them
- B. B. Convert all connectors to Skills

- C. C. Enable write access only for the most frequently used connector
- D. D. Put all connectors inside a Project

Answer: A

Question 14

A Skill works perfectly until the organization changes its reporting template and withholding policy. The Skill file was not changed, but outputs are now wrong. What is the most likely explanation?

- A. A. Progressive disclosure has permanently corrupted the Skill
- B. B. The Skill has become stale relative to surrounding workflow inputs and assumptions
- C. C. MCP prevents Skills from reading updated policies
- D. D. The model can no longer fire Skills automatically

Answer: B

Question 15

An FDE needs to decide whether a new automation deserves a Skill. The customer performs the task once every two years and has no consistent personal procedure beyond the desired outcome. What is the strongest recommendation?

- A. A. Build a Skill anyway because every repeatable business task needs one
- B. B. Create a Connector first and let the connector remember the procedure
- C. C. Put the task in custom instructions for global availability
- D. D. Keep it as a good prompt unless a repeated, specific way of doing it emerges

Answer: D

Question 16

A customer asks for a cross-tool workflow that should work in Claude Code and another vendor's CLI. They want to avoid rewriting the procedure for each tool. Which artifact is the strongest portability target according to the course?

- A. A. A consumer-chat saved assistant
- B. B. A vendor-specific Project
- C. C. A standard SKILL.md following the Agent Skills open standard
- D. D. A connector-specific configuration file

Answer: C

Question 17

A Skill fires correctly, but a connected-data answer is suspiciously based on information already present in the conversation rather than the latest source file. Which troubleshooting instruction is most appropriate?

- A. A. Tell the AI to use the connector to fetch the actual file and identify which file it used
- B. B. Rewrite the Skill's folder name in snake_case
- C. C. Grant whole-drive write access
- D. D. Disable progressive disclosure

Answer: A

Question 18

A team wants AI to update a production tracker after it has proven reliable at reading and summarizing issues. Which rollout strategy best balances capability and risk?

- A. A. Grant full write/delete access immediately because summaries are already correct
- B. B. Keep the connector read-only forever because write actions are inherently unsafe
- C. C. Scope the connector to the smallest required area and introduce write access only after observing reliable behavior
- D. D. Replace the connector with custom instructions

Answer: C

Question 19

A user wants the AI to apply the same eight-section board-paper structure every time, regardless of which app supplies the source data. Which feature is the cleanest place for the procedure?

- A. A. Connector
- B. B. Skill
- C. C. Project
- D. D. Custom instructions

Answer: B

Question 20

A customer's Skill is reliable on normal inputs but fails on edge cases. The FDE wants a test plan that can distinguish trigger failures from output-rule failures and expose hidden assumptions. Which TWO actions are most valuable?

- A. A. Test phrases that should activate the Skill and unrelated phrases that should not

- B. B. Grant broader connector scope before testing
- C. C. Test awkward cases such as empty income, exact-threshold payments, and messy ledgers
- D. D. Replace the Skill with a Project before collecting evidence
- E. E. Test only the happy path repeatedly
- F. F. Remove all examples from the Skill

Correct answers: A,C

Question 21

A regulated-data pilot is about to connect an application containing sensitive records. The customer wants a low-risk first deployment. Which TWO controls best match the course?

- A. A. Give the connector organization-wide access so retrieval failures are rare
- B. B. Start read-only
- C. C. Enable write/delete access but require users to trust the model
- D. D. Scope access to the smallest folder/app needed
- E. E. Install a random community Skill to validate the workflow
- F. F. Put credentials into the Skill description

Correct answers: B,D

Question 22

A Skill is firing too broadly, but its actual report-generation instructions are correct. The customer uses several informal phrases for the intended task and also asks unrelated one-off calculations in the same chat. Which TWO changes directly target activation precision?

- A. A. Add the real phrases users say to the description
- B. B. Move the instructions into a Connector
- C. C. Add a negative trigger for one-off calculations
- D. D. Grant the Skill write access
- E. E. Put the report template in custom instructions
- F. F. Increase the connector scope

Correct answers: A,D

Question 23

A recurring workflow requires current data from Gmail and a highly standardized output. The FDE wants the solution to remain maintainable as the email source changes. Which TWO design decisions best separate concerns?

- A. A. Encode the output procedure in a Skill
- B. B. Hard-code the latest email contents into the Skill
- C. C. Use a Connector to retrieve live Gmail data
- D. D. Put Gmail permissions into custom instructions
- E. E. Make the Project responsible for performing the report logic
- F. F. Require users to paste each email into chat

Correct answers: B,C

Question 24

A team is auditing an unfamiliar Skill before allowing it near customer information. Which TWO findings should trigger heightened scrutiny?

- A. A. The Skill contains a clear description with exact trigger phrases
- B. B. A bundled program contacts an external server
- C. C. The Skill uses a references folder for detailed documentation
- D. D. Instructions request handling credentials or sending data externally
- E. E. The folder uses kebab-case
- F. F. The Skill has a negative trigger

Correct answers: C,D

Question 25

A generated Skill repeatedly makes the same arithmetic mistake on every run even after its natural-language instructions are tightened. Which TWO conclusions follow most directly from the course's debugging guidance?

- A. A. The exact step may belong in a small program
- B. B. The connector should be granted write access
- C. C. The model needs a longer chat
- D. D. The error is likely caused by progressive disclosure alone
- E. E. Deterministic computation should be represented in a form that executes exactly
- F. F. The Skill should become a Project

Correct answers: A,E

Question 26

A customer reports that a previously correct Skill now produces wrong reports, but the Skill file has not changed. Which TWO investigation paths are justified before rewriting the Skill?

- A. A. Compare the current threshold/template/data source with what the Skill assumes
- B. B. Immediately delete the Skill and recreate it
- C. C. Check whether team workflow or source files changed
- D. D. Disable all connectors permanently
- E. E. Replace the model without collecting evidence
- F. F. Add a negative trigger

Correct answers: B,D

Question 27

A customer wants an AI workflow that reads a tracker, applies a repeatable review checklist, and creates a new issue when a serious finding is detected. Which TWO capabilities are essential to satisfy the full workflow?

- A. A. A Skill containing the review/checklist procedure
- B. B. Custom instructions only
- C. C. A Connector with appropriate access to the tracker
- D. D. A Project with no external access
- E. E. A connector is unnecessary because Skills can read apps
- F. F. A global preference for concise responses

Correct answers: C,E

Question 28

A customer support FDE is diagnosing a production workflow that uses a Skill plus a CRM Connector. The same customer has reported four different symptoms over two days. The team wants to change as little as possible until the failure mode is isolated. Based only on the observations below, what is the best first intervention for the symptom in Row 3?

Observation	When it happens	Likely layer	Evidence	Best first move
1. Skill never activates	From first request	Trigger description	Explicit naming works	Tighten/add trigger phrases
2. Correct initially, degrades in long chat	Only after long conversation	Conversation context	Fresh chat works	Start fresh chat
3. Finds stale customer record	Intermittently	Data/connector path	CRM contains newer record	Verify connector fetches current record
4. Miscalculates threshold	Every run	Exact computation	Wording changes do not fix it	Move exact check into code

- A. A. Rewrite the Skill description to add more trigger phrases
- B. B. Start a fresh chat and leave the Skill unchanged
- C. C. Verify the connector retrieves the current CRM record before changing the Skill
- D. D. Move the threshold calculation into a small program

Answer: C

Question 29

An accounting automation uses a monthly-summary Skill and Drive Connector. The customer's policy says a payment exactly at the threshold must NOT be flagged, while payments above it must be flagged. The FDE runs controlled tests before approving write access. Which test result is acceptable evidence for the boundary rule?

Test case	Input	Observed result	Interpretation	Decision
A	49,999	Not flagged	Below threshold behaves correctly	Pass
B	50,000	Flagged	Boundary violates policy	Fail
C	50,001	Flagged	Above threshold behaves correctly	Pass
D	50,000	Not flagged	Exact boundary matches policy	Pass
E	Messy ledger	Unstable grouping	Data quality issue remains	Investigate

- A. A. Test A only, because below-threshold behavior is sufficient
- B. B. Test B, because flagging the boundary proves the rule is conservative
- C. C. Test C, because above-threshold behavior is the only production case that matters
- D. D. Test D, because the exact boundary must match the stated policy

Answer: D

Question 30

A marketing team is choosing where to place four pieces of configuration. The goal is to minimize unnecessary global behavior while keeping live source data separate from reusable procedure. Which mapping best fits the architecture described in the source?

Item	Option 1	Option 2	Option 3	Option 4
Brand caption procedure	Skill	Connector	Project	Custom instruction
This week's Notion posts	Skill	Connector	Project	Custom instruction
Client-specific standing files	Skill	Connector	Project	Custom instruction
Global preference: concise replies	Skill	Connector	Project	Custom instruction
Candidate mapping	1,2,3,4	4,1,3,2	1,2,3,4	3,1,2,4

- A. A. Brand procedure → Skill; posts → Connector; standing files → Project; global preference → custom instructions
 B. B. Brand procedure → Connector; posts → Skill; standing files → Project; global preference → custom instructions
 C. C. Brand procedure → Skill; posts → Project; standing files → Connector; global preference → custom instructions
 D. D. Brand procedure → custom instructions; posts → Connector; standing files → Project; global preference → Skill

Answer: A

Question 31

A security review compares four proposed connector configurations for a pilot that only needs to summarize one folder. The organization wants the smallest practical blast radius. Which configuration is the strongest starting point?

Config	Access	Scope	Actions	Risk posture
A	Read-only	One folder	Search/summarize	Low
B	Write	Whole drive	Edit/delete	High
C	Read-only	Whole drive	Search/summarize	Medium
D	Write	One folder	Edit/delete	Medium
E	Write	One folder	Search only	Higher than A

- A. A. A — read-only, one-folder scope, search/summarize
 B. B. B — write access across the whole drive for completeness
 C. C. C — read-only whole-drive access because it avoids writes
 D. D. D — write access limited to one folder because the scope is small

Answer: A

Question 32

An FDE is deciding why five Skills behave differently in production. The timing of failure is known and the Skill files have not all changed. Which diagnosis best matches the behavior in Row 4?

Case	Observed behavior	Timing	Best diagnosis	First response
1	Never fires	Immediately	Description too vague	Improve description
2	Fires on unrelated requests	Immediately	Description too broad	Narrow/add negative trigger
3	Fires but output rule is inconsistent	Immediately	Instruction is loose	Make rule explicit
4	Worked, then broke after policy change	After environment change	Surrounding workflow changed	Review assumptions
5	Works early, degrades in long chat	Later	Context issue	Fresh chat

- A. A. Treat it as a trigger-description problem and add phrases
 B. B. Treat it as a long-chat context problem and start fresh
 C. C. Treat it as a loose-instruction problem and clarify the rule
 D. D. Review the changed policy/template/data assumptions around the unchanged Skill

Answer: D

Question 33

A customer is evaluating portability. The team wants one reusable procedure across Claude.ai, Claude Code, and another compatible CLI. The table summarizes candidate artifacts. Which candidate best satisfies the portability requirement while preserving a reusable procedure?

Artifact	Primary property	Cross-tool portability	Vendor-specific install	Best use
A	Consumer saved assistant	Low	Yes	Single-vendor chat
B	Project workspace	Low	Yes	Standing context
C	SKILL.md standard	High	Yes, per tool	Reusable procedure
D	Custom instruction	Low	Yes	Global preference
E	Connector config	Variable	Often	App access

- A. A. Consumer saved assistant, because it is easiest to install
 B. B. Project workspace, because standing context is automatically reusable
 C. C. SKILL.md following the Agent Skills standard, because the procedure can travel across compatible tools

D. D. Custom instructions, because they are not tied to a single workflow

Answer: C

Question 34

A team is troubleshooting a CRM workflow. The connector is enabled, the user can open the CRM record manually, and the Skill is known to fire. The table shows retrieval results. Which next action is most justified?

Test	User can access record	Connector scope	Retrieved record	Signal
1	Yes	Correct account	Latest	Healthy
2	Yes	Correct account	Stale	Retrieval problem
3	No	Correct account	None	User permission issue
4	Yes	Wrong account	Correct for wrong account	Scope/selection issue
5	Yes	Correct account	Latest	Healthy

- A. A. Rewrite the Skill because the connector is already enabled
- B. B. Investigate the connector's retrieval path/scope because it returned stale data despite valid user access
- C. C. Grant whole-organization access to eliminate possible scope issues
- D. D. Start a fresh chat because stale data always indicates context loss

Answer: B

Question 35

An organization has four deployment proposals for an AI workflow that reads data, applies a Skill, and may later write results. The customer wants evidence before increasing capability. Which proposal follows the safest progression described in the course?

Proposal	Initial access	Scope	Validation	Next step
A	Write	Whole app	No pilot	Deploy
B	Read-only	Smallest required scope	Test trigger/output/edge cases	Consider write only after observed reliability
C	Write	Smallest scope	Happy path only	Deploy
D	Read-only	Whole organization	No edge cases	Enable delete
E	Write	Small scope	Long-chat test only	Deploy

- A. A. Proposal A, because broad access reduces retrieval uncertainty
- B. B. Proposal B, because it starts read-only, stays narrow, tests behavior, then considers write access
- C. C. Proposal C, because small scope makes immediate write deployment acceptable
- D. D. Proposal D, because read-only access is sufficient even when deletion is planned

Answer: B

Verification: exactly 35 questions = 19 single-answer + 8 two-answer + 8 table-based. Table answers are derived from table evidence; answer positions are varied.